DAY 4 | EXCEL

My Data Analyst Journey

Go To Special, Paste Special & Cell References

Day 4 of learning Excel in public.

Ctrl G F4 $

Swipe to learn with me >

Go To & Go To Special

Jump or select with precision

Name Box

Type a cell address (like D50) and press Enter.

Go To Dialog

Ctrl+G or F5, or Home > Find & Select > Go To. Type the reference > OK.

Go To Special

Selects only certain kinds of cells: formulas, constants, blanks and more.

Steps

Select your data range > Ctrl+G > Special > choose an option > OK.

Go To Special Options

What can it select?

Constants	Typed numbers/text
Formulas	Cells with formulas
Blanks	Empty cells
Visible cells only	Skips hidden rows
Current Region	Whole data block
Objects	All shapes at once
Conditional formats	Cells with rules
Data validation	Cells with dropdowns

Shortcuts: Alt+; = Visible cells only. Ctrl+Shift+ = Current Region (like Ctrl+A). Current Array selects an array formula such as F117:G127.*

Constants vs Formulas

Click a cell and check the Formula Bar

	Constant	Formula
Formula Bar shows	Typed value	**= formula**
Example	100 or Ali	**=A1+B1**
Logical	TRUE / FALSE typed	**=A1>5**
Errors	#N/A typed	**=some > #NAME?**
Changes when	You edit it	**Its cells change**

> *Under Constants and Formulas you can further pick Numbers, Text, Logicals or Errors.*

Clear & Convert

Clean up cells fast

Clear all (data + format)	Alt + H + E + A
Clear formatting only	Alt + H + E + F
Clear contents only	Alt + H + E + C
Formulas to values	Ctrl + Alt + V + V
Apply date format	Ctrl + Shift + #

Formulas to values: select > Ctrl+C > Ctrl+Alt+V > V > Enter. Pasted dates showing as big numbers? They are serial numbers - apply the date format.

Delete Blank Rows

Go To Special > Blanks

Step 1

Select your data range.

Step 2

Press Ctrl+G > Special > Blanks > OK.

Step 3

Press Ctrl + - and choose Entire row > OK.

Careful!

Any row with even one blank cell gets deleted. Select one key column (like ID) first.

Select by Difference

Great for auditing and checking

Row differences	Ctrl + \
Column differences	Ctrl + Shift + |
Current region	Ctrl + Shift + *
Visible cells only	Alt + ;
Select precedent cells	Ctrl + [
Select dependent cells	Ctrl +]

Use it to reconcile data, like comparing invoice entries (INV-764512) between two columns.

Row & Column Differences

Spot what does not match

Row Differences

Compares cells across each row. Select both columns, press Ctrl+\. Cells that differ from the first column get selected.

Column Differences

Compares cells down each column. Select the rows, press Ctrl+Shift+|.

Example

Column 1: 1, 2, 3, 5 and Column 2: 1, 3, 4, 5. Rows 2 and 3 differ, so they are selected.

Visible Cells Only

Copy only what you can see

The Problem

Copying a range with hidden or filtered rows also copies the hidden rows.

The Fix

Select the range > Ctrl+G > Special > Visible cells only > OK (or Alt+;).

Then

Ctrl+C and Ctrl+V. Only visible cells are pasted.

Bonus

Go To Special > Conditional formats selects every cell that has a rule.

Formula Auditing

See how cells connect

Trace Precedents	Alt + M + P
Trace Dependents	Alt + M + D
Remove arrows	Alt + M + A
Jump to precedent cells	Ctrl + [
Jump to dependent cells	Ctrl +]
Show / hide all formulas	Ctrl + `

Precedents = which cells feed this formula. Dependents = which cells use this cell. Example: 1000 = 50 x 20, so 50 and 20 are precedents.

Paste Special Math

Calculate without formulas

Add	Ctrl + Alt + V + D
Subtract	Ctrl + Alt + V + S
Multiply	Ctrl + Alt + V + M
Divide	Ctrl + Alt + V + I

Example - add 1000 to every salary: type 1000 in a cell > Ctrl+C > select the salary column > Ctrl+Alt+V > Add > OK.

Paste Special Tools

Ctrl + Alt + V, then a letter

Values only	Ctrl + Alt + V + V
Transpose	Ctrl + Alt + V + E
Paste Link	Ctrl + Alt + V + L
Skip blanks	Ctrl + Alt + V + B
All except borders	Ctrl + Alt + V + X
Formulas + number format	Ctrl + Alt + V + R
Values + number format	Ctrl + Alt + V + U
Column widths	Ctrl + Alt + V + W

Paste Special in Action

Four tricks to remember

Percent Trick

Marks like 65, 75, 85: type 100 > copy > select marks > Paste Special > Divide > format as %.

Skip Blanks

Blank cells in the copied range do not erase data already in the destination.

Paste Link

Pasted cells update when the source changes. Works across sheets and workbooks.

Transpose

Turns rows into columns and columns into rows. Format Painter: Alt+H+F+P.

Find & Replace

Search and fix in bulk

Find — Ctrl + F

Replace — Ctrl + H

Replace All (in dialog) — Alt + A

Find All (in dialog) — Alt + I

*Click Options for Match case, Match entire cell, search in Sheet or Workbook, and look in Formulas or Values. Wildcards: * = any text, ? = any one character.*

Cell References

The $ sign locks

A1 — Relative: row and column both change

A1 — Absolute: both locked

$A1 — Mixed: column locked

A$1 — Mixed: row locked

Press F4 (Fn+F4 on many laptops) while the cursor is on a reference. It cycles A1, A1, A$1, $A1.

Percentage Example

Why F1 matters

Scenario

Marks of Person A, B, C, D divided by total marks (400 in F1).

Formula

=G5/F1 then drag down. F1 stays fixed, G5 moves to G6, G7...

Without $

F1 shifts to F2, F3 while dragging and you get wrong answers.

Why Not Type 400?

It works, but if the total becomes 500 you must edit every cell. One cell reference fixes all.

Format

Press Ctrl+Shift+% to show 0.50 as 50%.

Day 4
Done!

Go To Special, Paste Special
and cell references.

Which Go To Special option will you use first?
Tell me in the comments.

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